



# Rockstor

## The Rockstar among NAS Solutions

This article is a tutorial on using Rockstor, particularly for setting up multi-period snapshots. The author discusses the various features of Rockstor and its installation, before moving on to cover snapshots and how to manage backups.

**R**ockstor is a Linux based NAS distro powered by the B-tree file system, also called BTRFS. This NAS and cloud storage platform is suitable for small to medium businesses and home users who have little IT experience, but who need several hundred gigabytes or even terabytes of data storage. The advantage of an open source DIY solution like Rockstor, compared to older NAS solutions, is that users can choose their own hardware and easily build an advanced NAS solution. Using a tailor made NAS solution offers many advantages over other options. In fact, many of these advantages form the 12 governing principles of the Rockstor

project. These principles are: user empowerment, privacy, simplicity, open source, hardware agnosticism, security, ease of use, interoperability, cost effectiveness, scalability, resource-lightness and incremental development. Each of these principles (explained on the Rockstor wiki) is reflected in all aspects of the Rockstor project - from community-centric development and system requirements, to the implementation of feature sets and storage management. These principles will become clear once you deploy it for your use-case and tinker with its features.

The Rockstor NAS and cloud storage platform can be managed within a LAN or over the Web using a simple